

Typesetting captions with the `caption` package*

Axel Sommerfeldt
`caption@sommerfeldt.net`

2004/01/22

Abstract

The `caption` package provides many ways to customise the captions in floating environments such `figure` and `table` and cooperates with many other packages.

1 Introduction

Within the standard $\text{\LaTeX}$ classes captions haven't received the attention they deserve. Simply typeset as an ordinary paragraph there is no remarkable visual difference from the rest of the text, like here:

Figure 1: White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe's finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

There should be possibilities to change this; e.g., it would be nice if you can make the text of the caption a little bit smaller as the normal text, add an extra margin, typeset the caption label with the same font family and shape as your headings etc. Just like this one:

Figure 2: White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe's finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

With this package you can do this easily as there are many ready-to-use caption formatting options, but you are free to define your very own stuff, too.

*This package has version number v3.0a, last revised 2004/01/23.

2 Using the package

`\usepackage` Insert

```
\usepackage[<options>]{caption}[2004/01/23]
```

into the preamble of your document, i.e. the part of your document between `\documentclass` and `\begin{document}`. The options control how your captions will look like; e.g.,

```
\usepackage[margin=10pt,font=small,labelfont=bf]{caption}
```

would result in captions looking like the second one in the introduction.

`\captionsetup` For a later change of options the `caption` package provides the command

```
\captionsetup[<float type>]{<options>}
```

So

```
\usepackage[margin=10pt,font=small,labelfont=bf]{caption}
```

and

```
\usepackage{caption}  
\captionsetup{margin=10pt,font=small,labelfont=bf}
```

are equal in their results.

It's good to know that `\captionsetup` has an effect on the current environment only. So if you want to change some settings for the current **figure** or **table** only, just place the `\captionsetup` command inside the **figure** or **table** right before the `\caption` command. For example

```
\begin{figure}  
...  
\captionsetup{singlelinecheck=off}  
\caption{...}  
\end{figure}
```

switches the single-line-check off, but only for this **figure** so all the other captions remain untouched.

(For a description of the optional parameter *<float type>* see section 4: “*Useful stuff*”.)

3 Options

3.1 Formatting

format= A figure or table caption mainly consists of three parts: the caption label, which says if this object is a ‘Figure’ or ‘Table’ and what number is associated with it, the caption text itself, which is normally a short description of contents, and the caption separator which separates the text from the label.

The *caption format* determines how this information will be presented; it is specified with the option

`format=<format name>` ,

having the name of the caption format as its argument.

There are two standard caption formats:¹

default Typesets the captions as a normal paragraph. (This is the default behaviour, it is adapted from the standard L^AT_EX document classes.)

hang Indents the caption text, so it will ‘hang’ under the first line of the text.

An example: Specifying the option

`format=hang`

yields captions like this:

Figure 3: White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe’s finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

indentation= For both formats (**default** and **hang**) you can setup an extra indentation starting at the second line of the caption. You do this with the option

`indentation=<amount>`.

Two examples:

`format=default,indentation=.5cm`

Figure 4: White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe’s finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

`format=hang,indentation=-0.5cm`

Figure 5: White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe’s finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

labelformat= With the option

`labelformat=<label format name>`

you specify how the caption label will be typeset. There are three standard caption label formats:

empty The caption label will be empty. This option only makes sense when used together with other options like **labelsep=none**.

¹You have the option to define your own ones, too. See section 5: “*Do it yourself!*” for details.

simple The caption label will be typeset as a name and a number. (This is the default behaviour.)

parens The number of the caption label will be typeset in parentheses.

An example: Using the options

```
labelformat=parens,labelsep=quad
```

yields captions like this one:

Figure (6) White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe's finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

labelsep= With the options

```
labelsep=<label separator name>
```

you specify what caption separator will be used. You can choose one of the following:

none There is no caption separator. This option only makes sense when used together with other options like **labelformat=empty**.

colon The caption label and text will be separated by a colon and a space. (This is the default one.)

period The caption label and text will be separated by a period and a space.

space The caption label and text will be separated by a single space.

quad The caption label and text will be separated by a `\quad`.

newline The caption label and text will be separated by a line break (`\newline`).

Two examples:

```
labelsep=period
```

Figure 7. White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe's finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

```
labelsep=newline
```

Figure 8

White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe's finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

3.2 Justification

`justification=` As addition to the caption format you could also specify a *caption justification*; it is specified with the option

`justification=⟨justification name⟩` .

You can choose one of the following:

- | | |
|--------------------------|---|
| <code>justified</code> | Typesets the caption as a normal paragraph. (This is the default.) |
| <code>centering</code> | Each line of the caption will be centered. |
| <code>centerlast</code> | The last line of each paragraph of the caption text will be centered. |
| <code>centerfirst</code> | Only the first line of the caption will be centered. |
| <code>raggedright</code> | Each line of the caption will be moved to the left margin. |
| <code>RaggedRight</code> | Each line of the caption will be moved to the left margin, too. But this time the command <code>\RaggedRight</code> of the <code>ragged2e</code> package will be used to achieve this. This difference is that this time the word breaking algorithm of <code>T_EX</code> will work inside the caption. |
| <code>raggedleft</code> | Each line of the caption will be moved to the right margin. |

Two examples:

`justification=centerlast`

Figure 9: White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe’s finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

`format=hang,justification=raggedright`

Figure 10: White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe’s finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

`singlelinecheck=` If the caption fit in a single line it will always be centered, ignoring the justification you set:

Figure 11: A short caption.

This behaviour is adapted from the standard `LATEX` document classes `article`, `report`, and `book`), but using the `caption` package you can switch this special treatment of such short captions off with the option

`singlelinecheck={⟨bool⟩}` .

Using `false`, `no`, `off` or `0` for `⟨bool⟩` you switch off the extra centering:

`singlelinecheck=false`

Doing so the above short caption would look like

Figure 12: A short caption.

Using `true`, `yes`, `on` or `1` for $\langle bool \rangle$ you switch on the extra centering again. (The default is on.)

3.3 Fonts

`font=` There are three font options which affects different parts of the caption: One affecting the whole caption (`font`), one which only affects the caption label and separator (`labelfont`) and at last one which only affects the caption text (`testfont`).
`labelfont=`
`testfont=` You set them up using the options

`font={\font options}` ,
`labelfont={\font options}` and
`testfont={\font options}` .

And these are the available font options:

<code>scriptsize</code>	Very small size
<code>footnotesize</code>	The size usually used for footnotes
<code>small</code>	Small size
<code>normalsize</code>	Normal size
<code>large</code>	Large size
<code>Large</code>	Even larger size
<code>up</code>	Upright shape
<code>it</code>	<i>Italic shape</i>
<code>sl</code>	<i>Slanted shape</i>
<code>sc</code>	SMALL CAPS SHAPE
<code>md</code>	Medium series
<code>bf</code>	Bold series
<code>rm</code>	Roman family
<code>sf</code>	Sans Serif family
<code>tt</code>	Typewriter family

If you use only one of these options you can omit the braces; e.g., the options `font={small}` and `font=small` yield the same result.

Two examples:

```
font={small,it},labelfont=bf
```

Figure 13: *White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe's finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.*

```
font=small,labelfont=bf,textfont=it
```

Figure 14: *White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe's finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.*

3.4 Margins and further paragraph options

margin= For all captions you can specify *either* an extra margin *or* a fixed width. You do
width= this using the options

```
margin=<amount>    or  
width=<amount>
```

Nevertheless what option you use, the left and right margin will be the same.

Two examples illustrating this:

```
margin=10pt
```

Figure 15: White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe's finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

```
width=.75\textwidth
```

Figure 16: White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe's finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

parskip= This option is useful for captions containing more than one paragraph. It specifies the extra vertical space inserted between them:

```
parskip=<amount>
```

One example:

```
margin=10pt,parskip=5pt
```

Figure 17: First paragraph of the caption. This one contains some test, just to show how these options affect the layout of the caption.

Second paragraph of the caption. This one contains some text, too, to show how these options affect the layout of the caption.

`hangindent=` The option

`hangindent=<amount>`

is for setting up a hanging indentation starting from the second line of each paragraph. If the caption contains just a single paragraph, using this option leads to the same result as the option `indentation=` you already know about. But if the caption contains multiple paragraphs you will notice the difference:

`format=hang,indentation=-.5cm`

Figure 18: First paragraph of the caption. This one contains some test, just to show how these options affect the layout of the caption.

Second paragraph of the caption. This one contains some text, too, to show how these options affect the layout of the caption.

`format=hang,hangindent=-.5cm`

Figure 19: First paragraph of the caption. This one contains some test, just to show how these options affect the layout of the caption.

Second paragraph of the caption. This one contains some text, too, to show how these options affect the layout of the caption.

3.5 Styles

`style=` A suitable combination of caption options is called *caption style*. You can compare them more or less to page styles which you set up with `\pagestyle`: The caption style provides all settings for a whole caption layout.

You switch to an already defined caption style with the option

`style=<style name> .`

The `caption` package usually defines only the style `default` which puts all options you already know about to the default ones. This means that specifying the option

`style=default`

has the same effect as specifying all these options:

`format=default,labelformat=simple,labelsep=colon,
justification=justified,font=default,labelfont=default,
textfont=default,margin=0pt,indentation=0pt,parindent=0pt
hangindent=0pt,singlelinecheck=true`

3.6 Skips

`aboveskip=` The spaces above and below the caption are controlled by the skips `\abovcaptionskip`
`belowskip=` and `\belowcaptionskip`. The standard L^AT_EX document classes `article`, `report` and `book` set `\abovcaptionskip` to 10pt and `\belowcaptionskip` to 0pt.

Both skips can be changed with the command `\setlength`, but you can use these options, too:

```
aboveskip=<amount> and
belowskip=<amount> .
```

position= Using `\abovecaptionskip` and `\belowcaptionskip` has a major design flaw: If the caption is typeset *above* (and not *below*) the figure or table they are not set up very useful at default, because there will be some extra space above the caption but no space between the caption and the figure or table itself. (Remember: `\belowcaptionskip` is usually set to 0pt.)

Please compare the spacing in these small tables:

Table 1: A table	<table style="margin: auto;"> <tr><td>A</td><td>B</td></tr> <tr><td>C</td><td>D</td></tr> </table>	A	B	C	D
A	B				
C	D				
<table style="margin: auto;"> <tr><td>A</td><td>B</td></tr> <tr><td>C</td><td>D</td></tr> </table>	A	B	C	D	Table 2: A table
A	B				
C	D				

But you can fix this by using the option `position=`: It specifies how the spacing above and below the caption will be used:

```
position=top (or position=above)
```

tells the `caption` package to use the spacing useful for caption *above* the figure or table and

```
position=bottom (or position=below)
```

tells the `caption` package to use the spacing useful for captions *below* the figure or table. (The last one is the default setting.)

So adding an extra `\captionsetup{position=top}` to the left example table gives you proper spacing around both captions:

Table 3: A table	<table style="margin: auto;"> <tr><td>A</td><td>B</td></tr> <tr><td>C</td><td>D</td></tr> </table>	A	B	C	D
A	B				
C	D				
<table style="margin: auto;"> <tr><td>A</td><td>B</td></tr> <tr><td>C</td><td>D</td></tr> </table>	A	B	C	D	Table 4: A table
A	B				
C	D				

(Technically speaking `\abovecaptionskip` and `\belowcaptionskip` will be swapped if you specify the option `position=top`, so in both cases `\abovecaptionskip` will be used between the caption and the figure or table itself.)

This option is especially useful when used together with the optional argument of the `\captionsetup` command. (See section 4: “*Useful stuff*” for details.) E.g.,

```
\captionsetup[table]{position=top}
```

tableposition= causes all captions within tables to be treated as captions *above* the table (regarding spacing around it). Because this is a very common setting the `caption` package offers an abbreviating option for the use with `\usepackage`:

```
\usepackage[... ,tableposition=top]{caption}
```

is equivalent to

```
\usepackage[...]{caption}
\captionsetup[table]{position=top}
```

4 Useful stuff

`\caption` The command

```
\caption[ $\langle lst\_entry \rangle$ ]{ $\langle heading \rangle$ }
```

typesets the caption inside a floating environment like `figure` or `table`. Well, you already know this, but what is new is the fact then when you leave the argument $\langle lst_entry \rangle$ empty, no entry in the list of figures or tables will be made; e.g.,

```
\caption[] {A figure without entry in the list of figures.}
```

`\caption*` The `longtable` package defines the command `\caption*` which typesets the caption without label and without entry in the list of tables. An example:

```
\begin{longtable}{cc}
  \caption*{A table}\\
  A & B \\
  C & D \\
\end{longtable}
```

looks like

A table

A	B
C	D

This package does it, too, so you can use this command now within every floating environment like `figure` or `table`. Additionally you can specify an entry for the list of figures or tables within square brackets, like here:

```
\begin{table}
  \caption*[List entry for the table]{A table}
  \begin{tabular}{cc}
    A & B \\
    C & D \\
  \end{tabular}
\end{table}
```

`\captionof` Sometimes you want to typeset a caption *outside* a floating environment, putting a figure within a `minipage` for instance. For this purpose the `caption` package offers the command

```
\captionof{ $\langle float\ type \rangle$ }[ $\langle lst\_entry \rangle$ ]{ $\langle heading \rangle$ }
```

Note that the first argument, the $\langle float\ type \rangle$, is mandatory here, because the `\captionof` command needs to know which name to put into the caption label (e.g. “Figure” or “Table”) and in which list to put the contents entry. An example:

```
\captionof{figure}{A figure}
\captionof{table}{A table}
```

typesets captions like this:

Figure 20: A figure

Table 6: A table

The star variant `\captionof*` has the same behaviour as the `\caption*` command: it typesets the caption without label and without entry to the list of figures or tables (if not specified otherwise).

Please use both `\captionof` and `\captionof*` only *inside* environments (like `minipage` or `\parbox`), otherwise a page break can appear between content and caption. Furthermore some strange effects could occur (e.g., wrong spacing around captions).

\ContinuedFloat Sometimes you want to split figures or tables without giving them their own reference number. This is what the command

`\ContinuedFloat`

is for; it should be used as first command inside the floating environment. It prevents the increment of the relevant counter so a figure or table with a `\ContinuedFloat` in it gets the same reference number as the figure or table before.

An example:

```
\begin{table}
\caption{A table}
...
\end{table}
...
\begin{table}\ContinuedFloat
\caption{A table (cont.)}
...
\end{table}
```

gives the following result:

Table 7: A table

...

Table 7: A table (cont.)

\captionsetup We already know the `\captionsetup` command (see section 2: “*Using the package*”), but this time we get enlighten about the optional argument `<float type>`. Remember, the syntax of this command is

`\captionsetup[<float type>]{<options>}` .

If a `<float type>` gets specified, all the `<options>` don’t change anything at this time. Instead they only get marked for a later use, when a caption inside of a floating environment of the particular type `<float type>` gets typeset. For example

`\captionsetup[figure]{<options>}`

forces captions within a `figure` environment to use the given *<options>*.

Here comes an example to illustrate this:

```
\captionsetup{font=small}
\captionsetup[figure]{labelfont=bf}
```

gives captions like this:

Figure 21: A figure

Table 8: A table

As you see the command `\captionsetup[figure]{labelfont=bf}` only changed the font of the figure caption labels, not touching all other ones.

`\clearcaptionsetup` If you want to get rid of these parameters marked for an automatic use within a particular environment you can use the command

`\clearcaptionsetup{<Typ>}` .

For example `\clearcaptionsetup{figure}` would clear the extra handling in the example above:

Figure 22: A figure

Table 9: A table

As *<float type>* you can usually give one of these only two: `figure` and `table`. But as we will see later some $\text{\LaTeX}$ packages exist (like the `float` package for example) who can define additional floating environments and these two commands also works with them.

5 Do it yourself!

If you don't get familiar with all the given formats, separators, justifications, fonts, and styles you can easily define your very own ones. For this purpose a family of commands is given to you which you should use in the preamble of your document. (This is the part between `\documentclass` and `\begin{document}`.)

`\DeclareCaptionFormat` You can define your own caption formats using the command

`\DeclareCaptionFormat{<name>}{<code using #1, #2 and #3>}` .

At usage the system replaces *#1* with the caption label, *#2* with the separator and *#3* with the text. So the standard format `default` is defined inside `caption.sty` as

`\DeclareCaptionFormat{default}{#1#2#3\par}`

`\DeclareCaptionLabelFormat` Likewise you can define your own caption label formats:

```
\DeclareCaptionLabelFormat{<name>}{<code using #1 and #2>}
```

At usage `#1` gets replaced with the name (e.g. “figure”) and `#2` gets replaced with the reference number (e.g. “12”).

`\bothIfFirst` When you define your own caption label formats and use the `subfig` package[6], too,
`\bothIfSecond` you must take care of empty caption label names. For this purpose the commands

```
\bothIfFirst{<first arg>}{<second arg>} and  
\bothIfSecond{<first arg>}{<second arg>}
```

are offered. `\bothIfFirst` tests if the first argument is empty, `\bothIfSecond` tests if the second argument is empty. If it is so both arguments get typeset, otherwise none of them.

For example the standard label format `simple` isn’t defined as

```
\DeclareCaptionLabelFormat{simple}{#1 #2} ,
```

because this could cause an extra space if `#1` is empty. Instead `simple` is defined as

```
\DeclareCaptionLabelFormat{simple}{\bothIfFirst{#1}{ }#2} ,
```

causing the space to appear only if the label name is present.

`\DeclareCaptionLabelSeparator` You can define your own caption label separators with

```
\DeclareCaptionLabelSeparator{<name>}{<code>} .
```

Again an easy example taken from `caption.sty` itself:

```
\DeclareCaptionLabelSeparator{colon}{: }
```

`\DeclareCaptionJustification` You can define your own caption justifications with

```
\DeclareCaptionJustification{<name>}{<code>} .
```

The `<code>` simply gets typeset just before the caption. E.g. using the justification `raggedright`, which is defined as

```
\DeclareCaptionJustification{raggedright}{\raggedright} ,
```

yields captions with all lines moved to the left margin.

`\DeclareCaptionFont` You can define your own caption fonts with

```
\DeclareCaptionFont{<name>}{<code>} .
```

For example this package defines the options `small` and `bf` as

```
\DeclareCaptionFont{small}{\small} and  
\DeclareCaptionFont{bf}{\bfseries} .
```

`\DeclareCaptionStyle` The best one comes at last: You can define your own caption styles with

```
\DeclareCaptionStyle{<name>}[<additional options>]{<options>}
```

Remember, caption styles are just a collection of suitable options, saved under a given name. You can wake up these options at any time with the option `style=<style name>`.

All caption styles are based on the default set of options. (See section 3.5: “*Styles*” for a complete list.) So you only need to specify options which are different to them.

If you specify `<additional options>` they get used in addition when the caption fits into a single line and this check was not disabled with the option `singlelinecheck=off`.

Again a very easy example taken from `caption.sty`:

```
\DeclareCaptionStyle{default}[justification=centering]{}
```

5.1 Examples

If you would like to have a colon *and* a line break as caption separator you could define it this way:

```
\DeclareCaptionLabelSeparator{period-newline}{. \newline}
```

Selecting this separator with `\captionsetup{labelsep=period-newline}` you get captions like this:

Figure 23.

White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe’s finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

For short captions—which fit into one single line—this separator may not be satisfying, even when the automatically centering process is switched off (with `singlelinecheck=off`):

Figure 24.

A figure.

An own caption style which selects another caption separator automatically puts this right:

```
\DeclareCaptionStyle{period-newline}%  
[labelsep=period]{labelsep=period-newline}
```

Figure 25. A figure.

If you would like to keep the centering of these captions an appropriate definition is

```
\DeclareCaptionStyle{period-newline}%  
[labelsep=period,justification=centering]%  
{labelsep=period-newline}
```

Using this definition short captions look like

Figure 26. A figure.

while long ones still have a line break after the caption label.

Another example: You want captions to look like this:

White sand beaches. The pink smoothness of the conch shell. A sea abundant with possibilities. Duty-free shops filled with Europe's finest gifts and perfumes. Play your favorite game of golf amidst the tropical greens on one of the many championship courses.

(Figure 27)

You could do it this way:

```
\DeclareCaptionFormat{reverse}{#3#2#1}
\DeclareCaptionLabelFormat{fullparens}{(\bothIfFirst{#1}{ }#2)}
\DeclareCaptionLabelSeparator{fill}{\hfill}
\captionsetup{format=reverse,labelformat=fullparens
              labelsep=fill,font=small,labelfont=it}
```

6 Using non-standard document classes

The `caption` package was developed using the standard document classes `article`, `report` and `book`. But it should work with other document classes, too. (If there are any difficulties about a special document class please don't hesitate to write me an e-mail. Thank you.)

If you would like to use the `caption` package with the KOMA-Script classes, you have to take into consideration that all the possibilities for customization of the captions the KOMA-Script classes have to offer will get lost. (And they have a lot of possibilities to offer!) So commands like `\captionabove`, `\captionbelow`, `\captionformat`, `\figureformat`, `\tableformat`, `\setcapindent`, `\setcaphanging` etc. will not work anymore. So make a wise decision!

7 Using other packages

The `caption` package contains special adaptations to other packages who handle with captions, too, so the captions always should look like you have specified them to look like.

These are the packages the `caption` package is adapted to:

<code>float</code>	Gives you the possibility to define new floating environments
<code>longtable</code>	Typesets tables spanned over multiple pages
<code>rotating</code>	Supports rotated figures and tables
<code>sidecap</code>	Offers captions <i>beside</i> figures or tables
<code>supertabular</code>	Typesets tables spanned over multiple pages

If a certain support is not desired you can switch it off using the `caption` package option

```
\usepackage[...,<package>=no]{caption} .
```

For example specifying the option `float=no` means you don't like the `caption` package to support the `float` package. (Note: You can specify these options only within the `\usepackage` command, especially *not* at a later time with `\captionsetup`.) For further information about the supported packages please take a look at the documentation belonging to it or buy yourself The L^AT_EX Companion[1].

7.1 The float package

A very useful feature is provided by the `float` package[2]: It offers the float placement specifier `H` which is much more restrictive than the specifier `h` offered by L^AT_EX. While the latter one is only a recommendation to L^AT_EX to set the float “here”, the `H` forces the float to appear exactly at the spot where it occurs in your input file and nowhere else.

Furthermore it offers different styles for floating environments, these styles are `plain`, `plaintop`, `ruled`, and `boxed`. You can link one of these styles to either new floating environments or to one of the existing environments `figure` and `table`.

If you are using the `caption` package together with the `float` package this caption style called `ruled` gets defined automatically:

```
\DeclareCaptionStyle{ruled}{labelfont=bf,labelsep=space}
```

This style represents the caption layout in `ruled` styled floats. For you as an end user this means that captions within `ruled` floats will always look like this, nevertheless what generic caption options do you specify:

Program 7.1 The first program. This hasn't got anything to do with the package but is included as an example. Note the `ruled` float style.

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main(int argc, char **argv)
{
    for (int i = 0; i < argc; ++i)
        printf("argv[%d] = %s\n", i, argv[i]);
    return 0;
}
```

If you want a different layout for `ruled` captions you have to define your own one using the command

```
\DeclareCaptionStyle{ruled}{\options}
```

This mechanism also works with all other float styles. If you want a special caption layout for `plain` or `boxed` floats for example you can simply define a suitable caption style with the same name as the float style.

7.2 The longtable package

The `longtable` package[3] offers the environment `longtable` which behaves similar to the `tabular` environment, but the table itself can span multiple pages.

7.3 The rotating package

The `rotating` package[4] offers the floating environments `sidewaysfigure` and `sidewaystable` which are just like normal figures and tables but rotated by 90 degree. Furthermore they always use a full page on their own.

7.4 The sidecap package

The `sidecap` package[5] offers the floating environments `SCfigure` and `SCtable` which are like normal figures and tables but the caption will be put *beside* the contents.

The `sidecap` package offers it's own options for justification. If set, they will override the one specified with the caption option `justification=` for captions beside their contents.

Using the `sidecap` package you will probably notice that setting caption options *inside* `SCfigure` or `SCtable` environments with `\captionsetup` won't work. This is caused by the implementation design of the `sidecap` package, so you'll have to take care of it. Furthermore suppressing the entry in the list of figures or tables with `\caption[]{\dots}` won't work inside these environments.

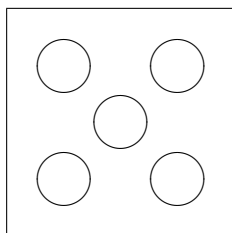


Figure 28: A small example with the caption beside the figure.

7.5 The supertabular package

The `supertabular` package[7] offers the environment `supertabular` which is quite similar to the `longtable` environment provided by the `longtable` package. Both offers the typesetting of tables which can span multiple pages. For a detailed discussion about the differences between these powerful packages please take a look at The L^AT_EX Companion[1].

8 Compatibility to older versions

8.1 caption version 1.x

This version of the `caption` package still supports the old options and commands provided by the version 1.x of this package. So there shouldn't occur any problems compiling old documents, but please don't mix old options and commands with the new ones. This isn't supported and can yield to ugly side effects.

Here comes a short oversight of the old options and commands and how they are replaced within this version of the `caption` package:

caption 1.x	caption 3.x
normal	format=default
hang	format=hang
isu	format=hang
center	justification=centering
centerlast	justification=centerlast
anne	justification=centerlast
nooneline	singlelinecheck=off
scriptsize	font=scriptsize
footnotesize	font=footnotesize
small	font=small
normalsize	font=normalsize
large	font=large
Large	font=Large
up	labelfont=up
it	labelfont=it
sl	labelfont=sl
sc	labelfont=sc
md	labelfont=md
bf	labelfont=bf
rm	labelfont=rm
sf	labelfont=sf
tt	labelfont=tt
<code>\setlength{\captionmargin}</code>	<code>margin=<amount></code>
<code>\renewcommand{\captionfont}</code>	<code>\DeclareCaptionFont</code> <code>+ \captionsetup{font=<name>}</code>
<code>\renewcommand{\captionsize}</code>	<code>\DeclareCaptionFont</code> <code>+ \captionsetup{font=<name>}</code>
<code>\renewcommand{\captionlabelfont}</code>	<code>\DeclareCaptionLabelFont</code> <code>+ \captionsetup{labelfont=<name>}</code>

8.2 caption2 version 2.x

Although they do very similar stuff the packages `caption` and `caption2` have a very different implementation design. So this version of the `caption` package isn't compatible to the `caption2` package at all. Of course for compiling old documents you can still use the `caption2` package, the latest version is provided with this package. But newly created documents shouldn't use the `caption2` package, please use the `caption` package instead as described in this manual.

9 Further reading

I recommend the following documents for further reading:

- The T_EX FAQ - Frequently asked questions about T_EX and L^AT_EX:

<http://faq.tug.org/>

- A French FAQ can be found at

<http://www.grappa.univ-lille3.fr/FAQ-LaTeX/>

- `epslatex` from Keith Reckdahl contains many tips around graphics in $\text{\LaTeX}$ 2 ϵ . You will find this document in the directory

`ftp://ftp.ctan.org/pub/tex/info/`

as `epslatex.ps` and `epslatex.pdf`.

There is also a french translation available:

`ftp://ftp.ctan.org/pub/tex/info/fepslatex.ps`

10 Thanks

I would like to thank Katja Melzner, Steven D. Cochran, Frank Mittelbach, David Carlisle, and Ivor Tiefenbrun.

References

- [1] Michel Goossens, Frank Mittelbach and Alexander Samarin: *The $\text{\LaTeX}$ Companion*, Addison-Wesley, Reading, Massachusetts, 2004.
- [2] Anselm Lingnau: *An Improved Environment for Floats*, 2001/11/08
- [3] David Carlisle: *The longtable package*, 2000/10/22
- [4] Sebastian Rahtz and Leonor Barroca: *A style option for rotated objects in $\text{\LaTeX}$* , 1997/09/26
- [5] Rolf Niepraschk und Hubert Gäßlein: *The sidecap package*, 2003/06/06
- [6] Steven D. Cochran: *The subfig package*, 2004/01/16
- [7] Johannes Braams und Theo Jurriens: *The supertabular environment*, 2002/07/19